

How much better?

Mesmas estruturas da aula: way/far/a lot/much para diferenças grandes, slightly/a bit/a little para diferenças pequenas, just as...as para igualdade, e not as...as / nowhere near as...as para nenhuma vantagem.

TEXTO ADAPTADO NÍVEL B1+

ganbare - you've got this

01 My Two Favourite Neighbourhoods

Leitura - By Yuki Tanaka

Shimokitazawa and Ginza are both in Tokyo, but they feel like different planets. Ginza is **way more polished**: glass buildings, luxury brands, everything perfectly in place. Shimokitazawa is **far more chaotic**, in the best way: narrow alleys¹, secondhand² shops, live music spilling out of tiny bars.

Prices are **not as far apart** as you'd expect. A coffee in Shimokitazawa is **only slightly cheaper** than one in Ginza, maybe fifty yen difference. The real gap is in what you buy, not what you pay.

Ginza is **nowhere near as walkable** at night as Shimokitazawa. After 9pm, Ginza empties out, quiet and closed. Shimokitazawa gets louder, busier, more alive.

Still, both neighbourhoods are **just as essential** to understanding Tokyo. One shows you the city's polish. The other shows you its texture. You need both to see the whole picture.

NOTAS DE LEITURA - GLOSSÁRIO

1. **alley**: a narrow street or passage between buildings (*beco, viela*; 路地)
2. **secondhand**: already owned or used by someone else before (*de segunda mão, usado*; 中古の)
3. **chaotic**: in a state of complete confusion, but often lively (*caótico(a)*; 混沌とした)
4. **walkable**: good or easy to walk around in (*bom para andar a pé*; 歩きやすい)
5. **essential**: extremely important, necessary (*essencial*; 不可欠な)

DIFERENÇA ENORME

way / far / a lot / much*"This hotel is way more expensive than that one."*

DIFERENÇA PEQUENA

slightly / a bit / a little*"The train is only slightly faster than the bus."*

SEM DIFERENÇA

just as ... as*"This restaurant is just as good as the other one."*

SEM VANTAGEM NENHUMA

not / nowhere near as ... as*"This hotel is nowhere near as comfortable as a ryokan."*

Regra de ouro: "way" e "far" só combinam com comparativos ("way better"), nunca com "as...as". Nunca "way as good as".

CONTEXTO	ESTRUTURA	EXEMPLO
Mochilas de 1.2kg vs. 4.8kg	Diferença enorme	This one is way lighter than that one.
Planos de dados de 5GB vs. 5.5GB	Diferença pequena	This plan is slightly more generous than that one.
Dois festivais com o mesmo público	Sem diferença	This festival is just as popular as that one.

02.1 Practice

02.01

Your backpack weighs 1.2kg. Your friend's weighs 4.8kg.

This backpack is _____ that one. (*light · diferença enorme*)

02.02

The listing said the station was a 5 minute walk away. It actually took 25 minutes on foot.

The station is _____ the listing claimed. (*close · sem vantagem nenhuma*)

02.03

One SIM card plan gives 5GB of data. Another, at the same price, gives 5.5GB.

This plan is _____ the other one. (*generous · diferença pequena*)

02.04

Both festivals drew exactly 40,000 visitors last year.

This festival is _____ that one. (*popular · sem diferença*)

02.05

One apartment has no natural light at all. The other is flooded with sunlight all day.

This apartment is _____ that one. (*bright · diferença enorme*)

02.06

Both tour guides have exactly the same rating and the same years of experience.

This guide is _____ that one. (*experienced · sem diferença*)

02.07

One phone screen measures 6.1 inches. The other measures 6.3 inches.

This phone's screen is _____ that one's. (*big · diferença pequena*)

02.08

A "5-star" hotel online turned out to have broken air conditioning and no hot water.

This hotel is _____ its online reviews suggest. (*luxurious · sem vantagem nenhuma*)

02.09

A one-way ticket on this bus line costs \$5. The other company charges \$45 for the same route.

This ticket is _____ that one. (*cheap · diferença enorme*)

02.10

Two neighbourhoods report crime rates of 2.1% and 2.3% for last year.

This neighbourhood is _____ that one. (*safe · diferença pequena*)

02.11

Two cafes both open at exactly 7am and close at exactly 10pm, every day of the week.

This cafe is _____ that one. (*convenient · sem diferença*)

02.12

A "handmade" souvenir turns out to be a mass-produced factory item with a "handmade" sticker on the box.

This souvenir is _____ it claims to be. (*authentic · sem vantagem nenhuma*)

03 Mixed Practice

03.01

Both suitcases weigh exactly 20kg, the airline's limit.

This suitcase is _____ that one. (*heavy · sem diferença*)

03.02

One phone's battery lasts 20 hours. The other lasts 6 hours.

This phone's battery life is _____ that one's. (*long · diferença enorme*)

03.03

A restaurant advertised as "authentic" turns out to use pre-made sauces from a supermarket.

This restaurant is _____ it claims to be. (*authentic · sem vantagem nenhuma*)

03.04

Two hostels charge \$18 and \$19 a night.

This hostel is _____ that one. (*expensive · diferença pequena*)

03.05

Two train tickets, same route, same class, same price, booked on the same day.

This ticket is _____ that one. (*comfortable · sem diferença*)

03.06

One phone charger fully charges the battery in 30 minutes. The other takes 3 hours.

This charger is _____ that one. (*fast · diferença enorme*)

04 Speaking Corner

DISCUSSION

- Think of two places you've visited that were very different in one way, but surprisingly similar in another. Be ready to describe both differences using qualifiers.
- Pick two items you own of the same type (two bags, two pairs of shoes). Compare them using at least two different qualifiers.

Answer Key - Gabarito

Practice

- 02.01: **way lighter than** (also: far lighter than)
02.02: **nowhere near as close as**
02.03: **slightly more generous than** (also: a bit more generous than)
02.04: **just as popular as**
02.05: **way brighter than** (also: far brighter than)
02.06: **just as experienced as**
02.07: **slightly bigger than** (also: a bit bigger than)
02.08: **nowhere near as luxurious as** (also: not as luxurious as)
02.09: **way cheaper than** (also: far cheaper than)
02.10: **slightly safer than** (also: a bit safer than)
02.11: **just as convenient as**
02.12: **nowhere near as authentic as** (also: not as authentic as)

Mixed Practice

- 03.01: **just as heavy as**
03.02: **way longer than** (also: far longer than)
03.03: **nowhere near as authentic as**
03.04: **slightly more expensive than**
03.05: **just as comfortable as**
03.06: **way faster than** (also: far faster than)